1916 at regional level), it never went for a *formal* national planning. In the 1940s, some economists had suggested in favour of the use of national planning. We may have a reflex of indicative planning in the USA if we look at the *Presidentail Reports* which come after regular intervals. These reports are just 'benchmarks' in the area of resource utilisation and governmental announcements of its objectives—basically trying to motivate the private sector towards the area of public objectives. The indicative planning as it is practised by the mixed economy, any growth target could only be achieved once the public and the private enterprises worked in tandem. This is why besides the plan targets, the governments need to announce some set of the indicative policies to encourage and motivate the private sector to accelerate their economic activities in the direction of the plan targets.

After the Second World War, almost all the newly independent countries adopted the route of planned development. Though they followed an overall model of the indicative planning, many of them had serious inclination towards imperative planning. As in the case of India, the heavy bias towards imperative planning could only be reformed once the process of economic reforms was started in 1991.

Today, as there are mostly only mixed economies around the world, any country's development planning has to be only of the indicative type. After the revival of the role and the need of market in promoting growth and development via the Washington Consensus (1985), the Santiago/New Consensus (1998) and the World Trade Organisation (1995), only indicative planning has remained possible with the state playing only a marginal role in the economy especially in the areas of social importance (i.e. nutrition, healthcare, drinking water, education, social security, etc.).

There are still many other types of planning depending upon the point of view we are looking with. For example, from the territorial point of view, planning could be ***regional*** or ***national.*** From the political point of view planning could be ***central, state*** or ***local.*** Similarly, from the participatory point of view, planning has been categorised into ***centralised*** and ***decentralised.*** Again, from the temporal point of view planning could be ***long-term*** or ***short-term*** (in relative sense). Finally, from the value point of view planning could be ***economic*** or ***developmental.***